



OUT OF THE 135 MATCHES, OR 270 POTENTIAL BATTING INNINGS, SCHEDULED FOR THE VIJAY HAZARE TROPHY, TEAMS TOUCHED OR BREACHED THE 300-RUN MARK ONLY 23 TIMES

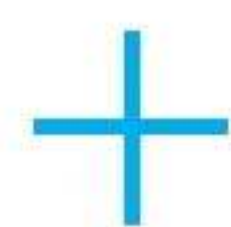
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Held under the shadow of India's World Cup final defeat and in a format overwhelmingly thought to be in limbo, the Vijay Hazare Trophy initially felt a little out of place.

In an age where the relevance of a format hinges on the ICC event scheduled to follow, in this case, the T20 World Cup in June 2024, it was tough to identify what the tournament set out to achieve.

Cricket, for the sake of it, is a concept that finds fewer takers by the minute, and every competition now either needs to entertain or unearth the next T20 sensation that could dazzle at the Indian Premier League (IPL).

But Haryana's maiden 50-over title triumph came as a timely reminder that domestic teams and states have their own life cycles, narrative arcs, and identities. The last time Haryana had won silverware was when Kapil Dev's side beat the Rest of India in the Irani Trophy in 1990-91 after handing the State team its first and only Ranji Trophy title in the same



Brief scores

Haryana 287/8 in 50 overs (Ankit Kumar 88, Ashok Menaria 70; Aniket Choudhary 4/49)

beat

Rajasthan 257 in 48 overs (Abhijeet Tomar 106, Kunal Rathore 79; Sumit Kumar 3/34, Harshal Patel 3/47) by 30 runs.